Waldorf Summer Camps for Children

Day camps, farm camps, arts camps and international residential camps, by country

A Waldorf summer camp is not a daycare with activities. Children get unhurried outdoor time, handwork, storytelling, watercolour painting, farm life, singing games, nature exploration and free creative play. There are no screens, and the rhythm of the day follows the seasons. Children are grouped by developmental age and led by Waldorf teachers. Many camps are open to all children, not just those at Waldorf schools.

USA and Canada

CAMP / SCHOOL	LOCATION	AGES	HIGHLIGHTS	WEBSITE
Earth and Sky Farm Community	*Wilton, New Hampshire*	All ages	Founded by Michaelann Murphy, a biodynamic farmer and Waldorf educator with a Master's in Waldorf Education and teaching certification from early childhood through high school. She has directed several early childhood centres and farm-based education programmes, and has served in Waldorf schools as pedagogical chair, on governance groups and as an early education mentor. She focuses on the healing of the earth and the therapeutic effects of agriculture and nature in children's lives. The farm is in Wilton, the same town as the Center for Anthroposophy. The website is still being built, so check back for programme details and registration. Facebook: Earth and Sky Farm Community · Instagram: @earthandskycommunity	earthandskyfarm.org
Summerfield Waldorf School & Farm	*Santa Rosa, California*	4–14	Farm Camp (gathering eggs, planting, picking berries, cooking organic snacks, crafts, songs, stories) and Circus & Aerial Arts Camp (clowning, juggling, tightrope, trapeze, acrobatics, with a showcase for families on the last day). Open to the public. Biodynamic farm setting.	summerfieldwaldorf.org/summer-camps
Marin Waldorf School	*San Rafael, California*	3–11	Early Childhood camp (crafts, water play, nature walks, free play). Camp G.R.O.W. for ages 7–10 (literacy, gardening, hiking, book-making). Vilda Nature Camp (creek exploration, carpentry, archery, outdoor skills). Handwork Camp (knitting, stitching, felting, plein air art). 10-acre campus.	marinwaldorf.org/summer-camp
Emerson Waldorf School	*Chapel Hill, North Carolina*	3–14	Weekly themed camps: Earth (roots, nature, belonging), Water (flow, rhythm, renewal) and Wood (growing, constructing, becoming). Arts and crafts, nature walks, water play, storytelling, weaving, stitching, woodworking, dance and Latin American cultural exploration. Open to all children.	emersonwaldorf.org/summercamps

CAMP / SCHOOL	LOCATION	AGES	HIGHLIGHTS	WEBSITE
Waldorf School of Orange County	*Costa Mesa, California*	18 months –14	Early Years (parent and child together), Early Childhood (natural toys, daily rhythm, outdoor sanctuary) and Grade School (First Grade Adventures, Art & Colour, Gardening, Craft Lab, Athletics, Wholesome Kitchen). Weekly sessions June to August. Open to families not enrolled at the school.	waldorfschool.com/summer-camps
Waldorf School of Philadelphia	*Philadelphia, Pennsylvania*	3–14	Summergarten for ages 3–5, built around the four elements. Camp Wonder for grades 1–3 (fairy tales, fantasy, circus, into the woods). Grade school camp (outdoor skills and survival, shelter building, fire making, an overnight adventure, Dungeons & Dragons, makers camp). Income-based scholarships available.	phillywaldorf.com/summer-camps
Lake Champlain Waldorf School	*Shelburne, Vermont*	4–15+	Early Childhood camps (morning circle, crafts, forest exploration, fairy house building, forts, quiet story time, outdoor games). Advanced Music Camp for rising Grades 6–10, a two-week intensive. Led by school teachers. Open to all children. Woodland campus.	lakechamplainwaldorfschool.org/summer-camp
Seacoast Waldorf School	*New Hampshire*	4–13	Six themed week-long camps on 5 acres of meadow, forest and playground: Nature Science, Woodcarving (Grades 4–8), Four Elements, Jungle Book theatre (performance for families on the last day) and Circus Arts (ages 6–13: unicycling, juggling, poi, diablo, stilt walking). Half-day option.	seacoastwaldorfschool.org/summer
Waldorf School of Garden City	*Garden City, New York*	4–13	Full-day and flexible scheduling. Early childhood: watercolour, crafts, singing, cooking, yoga, storytelling, puppetry. School age: tennis, pickleball, arts and crafts, painting, yoga, music, sports, gardening. Special events include Tie-Dye Week, Field Day and the Summertime Stars talent show. CIT leadership programme for ages 14+.	waldorfgarden.org/summer
Washington Waldorf School	*Bethesda, Maryland*	3–14	Hands-on summer fun based on the Waldorf curriculum, in several themed weeks. Open to all children.	washingtonwaldorf.org/summer-camps
Whidbey Island Waldorf School	*Whidbey Island, Washington*	3–12	Early Childhood and Grade camps on 116 acres of forest, fields and playgrounds. Nature, creativity and community, at each child's own pace. Led by experienced Waldorf teachers. Registered for 2026.	wiws.org/summercamps
Austin Waldorf School	*Austin, Texas*	3–14	Academic, artistic and practical activities in the Waldorf tradition, on the Austin campus.	austinwaldorf.org/summer-camp

CAMP / SCHOOL	LOCATION	AGES	HIGHLIGHTS	WEBSITE
Charlottesville Waldorf School	*Charlottesville, Virginia*	4–12	Summer Garden programme and a kindergarten camp (rhythm, nature, storytelling, water play, handcrafts, seasonal activities). Problem-solving, teamwork and outdoor nature-STEM play.	cwaldorf.org/summer-camps
Waldorf School of Palm Beach	*Palm Beach, Florida*	3.5–12	Themed weekly camps: Everyday Magic, Outer Space, Nature & Life and Ocean Discovery. Arts, crafts and storytelling for early childhood and grade school.	waldorfschoolpalmbeach.org/summer-program
South Shore Waldorf	*Nova Scotia, Canada*	8+	July and August programme with several sessions. Outdoor and creative activities.	waldorfns.org/summer-camps
Mountain Star Preschool	*Location not given*	Not given	Runs summer camps. No other details were provided, so check their page for dates, ages and registration. Handle: mountain.starpreschool	mountain.starpreschool

International camps

CAMP / SCHOOL	LOCATION	AGES	HIGHLIGHTS	WEBSITE
WESP (Waldorf Exchange Summer Program)	*Latvia (Adazi Free Waldorf School)*	8–17	Residential camp for about 70 children from Europe, America, Australia and Asia, in small groups of 10–15 by age. Outdoor activities, Waldorf teachers on staff, a doctor on site, and counsellors who are Waldorf graduates from around the world. Contact: wesp.latvia@gmail.com	motherground.com/summer-camps
Village Forest Summer Camp	*Montaldo, Monferrato, Italy*	4–14	Waldorf mixed with Forest School. Three weeks (July 6–24), bilingual English and Italian, in a quiet, toxin-free valley. Waldorf teachers, craftspeople, musicians, farmers and wilderness guides. Weekly workshops and organic meals. International families welcome. 2026 team forming.	villageforestschool.com/summer camp
Camphill Seasonal Camps	*UK, Germany, Switzerland and elsewhere*	6–18	Several Camphill communities run summer programmes for children, including those with additional needs. Inclusive, farm-based and life-sharing. Contact individual communities for current programmes.	camphill.org
Steiner Waldorf holiday camps	*United Kingdom*	Various	Several UK schools run summer programmes, including Michael Hall, Ringwood Waldorf, Edinburgh Steiner and Hereford Waldorf. Contact your nearest school. The Steiner Waldorf Schools Fellowship can connect you with programmes.	swsf.org.uk

CAMP / SCHOOL	LOCATION	AGES	HIGHLIGHTS	WEBSITE
Holiday programmes	*Australia*	Various	Schools usually run holiday programmes in January. Key schools: Sydney Rudolf Steiner School, Melbourne Steiner School and Glenaeon Rudolf Steiner School. Federation of Rudolf Steiner Schools in Australia.	steinereducation.edu.au
Holiday programmes	*South Africa*	Various	Schools run programmes in December and January and during school holidays. Contact Michael Oak, Constantia Waldorf or your nearest school. The Federation of Waldorf Schools SA has listings.	Local Waldorf schools
Summer activities	*Germany*	Various	Germany has the most Waldorf schools in the world (250+), and many run Ferienprogramme (holiday programmes) in summer. The Bund der Freien Waldorfschulen coordinates them.	waldorfschule.de

A typical day at a Waldorf summer camp

PART OF THE DAY	WHAT HAPPENS
Morning gathering and circle	Song, movement and seasonal verse. The group comes together before the day unfolds, often outdoors.
Morning craft or art	Watercolour painting, wet felting, knitting, woodcarving, weaving, bookmaking or natural dyeing, matched to the theme and the children's ages.
Outdoor free play	Unstructured time in nature: building forts and fairy houses, exploring creeks, climbing trees, digging, gardening. This is the heart of the day.
Lunch and rest	A shared meal, often with food the children grew or cooked. Quiet rest for the youngest, story time or reading for older children.
Afternoon activity	Water play, swimming, a nature walk, storytelling, singing games, theatre rehearsal, farm chores, outdoor games or cooking.
Closing circle	A closing song, verse or story. The day ends the way it began, together.

Types of camp

CAMP TYPE	BEST FOR	WHAT CHILDREN DO
Early Childhood / Kindergarten Camp	*Ages 3–6*	Gentle seasonal rhythm, songs, watercolour, nature walks, free play, water play, puppetry and cooking snacks.
Nature / Forest Camp	*Ages 5–12*	Creek exploration, fort building, fairy houses, plant and insect study, archery, carpentry and outdoor skills.

CAMP TYPE	BEST FOR	WHAT CHILDREN DO
Farm Camp	*Ages 4–10*	Gathering eggs, planting and harvesting, animal care, cooking organic food and biodynamic farming.
Arts Camp	*Ages 6–14*	Painting, drawing, sculpting, printmaking, ceramics, natural dyeing, book arts and illustrated journaling.
Handwork Camp	*Ages 7–14*	Knitting, felting, weaving, cross-stitch, natural dyeing and sewing, often ending in a take-home project.
Circus & Aerial Arts Camp	*Ages 6–14*	Juggling, unicycling, tightrope, trapeze, stilt walking, acrobatics, clowning, poi and diablo. A showcase for families ends the week.
Theatre & Performing Arts Camp	*Ages 7–14*	Learn and perform a story in a week, such as Jungle Book, a fairy tale or Shakespeare. Campers take all the roles.
Music Camp	*Ages 10–16*	Instrumental work, chamber music, choir and music theory for more experienced players, often over two weeks.
International Residential Camp	*Ages 8–17*	Multi-week overnight camp with children from many countries. Outdoor activities and language exchange.
CIT (Counsellor in Training)	*Ages 14+*	Leadership training for older teens in camp leadership, child development and personal awareness, often over two years.

Registration, scholarships and tips

TIP	DETAILS
Register in January	Most camps open registration in January or February and fill within days or weeks. Subscribe to camp newsletters from autumn so you get the announcement straight away.
Ask about scholarships	Almost every camp offers income-based scholarships, bursaries or sliding-scale fees. Many don't advertise them, so email the camp and ask.
Join the waitlist	If a session is full, join the waitlist. Plans change, and waitlisted families often get a place.
Open to all children	Most camps welcome children who don't attend the host school. Camp is often a family's first experience of Waldorf education.
Find your nearest camp	Every AWSNA-member school in North America is listed at awsna.org/find-a-waldorf-school. Most run summer programmes, so email or call even if the website doesn't mention one.
Southern Hemisphere timing	In Australia, New Zealand and South Africa, camps run December to January. Contact your nearest school from September.